Subclass 500

Student visa

Visit Australia to participate in a course of study.

Eligibility

Be a certain age (school student)

If you are a school student (but not participating in a secondary school student exchange program), you must be aged 6 or older to apply for this visa.

You must also be:

- less than 17 years old when you begin Year 9
- less than 18 years old when you begin Year 10
- less than 19 years old when you begin Year 11
- less than 20 years old when you begin Year 12

Be enrolled in a course of study and provide evidence

You must include the right evidence of enrolment in study with your Student visa application, or your application will not be valid and can't be processed.

Providing a Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE)

You must be enrolled in a full time course registered on the Commonwealth Register of Institutions and courses for Overseas Students (CRICOS) *(http://cricos.education.gov.au/)*.

You must provide a Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) for all intended courses when you apply.

If you do not provide a CoE at time of lodgement, the student visa application will be invalid.

Your CoE must be valid when we decide your application. A CoE is no longer valid if it is cancelled or the course is complete. If you finish your course, but still require a student visa, you will need to attach a new CoE to your ImmiAccount. You must maintain enrolment in a course of study to be eligible for a student visa.

Packaged courses and CoEs

If you are applying for more than one (1) course in your Student visa application, you must include all CoE codes in the application form, as your visa period may only consider the duration of the course according to the CoE provided.

Ask a question

You can apply to include two (2) or more courses on your Student visa where one course clearly leads to the next. Course gaps must be less than two calendar months, unless the first course finishes at the end of the standard academic year and the next course commences at the beginning of the standard academic year.

If you want your Student visa to cover more than one (1) course you must include all CoE codes in your visa application form, or your visa may only cover the CoE provided.

If you are a student visa holder and you meet an exemption to lodge a further Student visa in Australia, you cannot package courses together unless you are applying for:

- primary or secondary school studies, or
- a further visa because your education provider defaulted.

In all other scenarios, you can only apply in Australia for one further course.

Other evidence of enrolment

You do not need to provide a Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) if you are:

- enrolled in a full-time course of study or training under a scholarship scheme approved by the Australian Minister for Foreign Affairs and Trade: provide a letter of support
- sponsored by the Australian Department of Defence: provide a letter of support
- a secondary exchange student: provide an Acceptance Advice of Secondary Exchange Student (AASES) form
- a postgraduate research student who needs to stay in Australia while your thesis is marked: provide a letter from your education provider

---

Make Welfare arrangements if you are under 18 years

If you are applying for a Student visa and you are under 18 years of age, you must have adequate welfare arrangements in place while you are in Australia.

If you will be 18 years of age when you arrive in Australia, you must tell us as you might not need to provide some of this information.

To learn more, see Welfare arrangements for students under 18. *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/welfare-arrangements-students-under-18)*

Meet English language requirements

You might need to provide evidence of your English language skills when you submit your visa application. If you need to provide evidence of your English language skills, you must prove that you:

- have obtained a certain test score in an English language test that the Department has approved, or
- fall into an exemption category listed below.

For more information on the minimum overall band scores you must achieve to meet the Student visa English language requirements, go to Gather Documents in the 'Step by Step' tab *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#HowTo)*.

To find out if you need to provide evidence of your English language skills when you apply, use the Document Checklist tool *(/visas/web-evidentiary-tool)*.

English language tests

You must have completed the English language test:

- within the 2 years before you lodged your visa application, if you are Regular Evidence level; or
- within the 2 years before a decision is made on your visa application, if you are Streamlined Evidence level and the Department has requested evidence.

At-home or online English language tests

The Department of Home Affairs does not accept evidence from English language tests where an entire test is delivered online (also known as “remote-proctored” or “at-home”).

Examples of online tests that are not approved for Australian visa purposes, include:

- IELTS Online
- LANGUAGECERT Academic Online
- OET@Home
- CELPIP Online
- MET Digital (taken at-home)
- TOEFL iBT – Home Edition.

TOEFL iBT

From **21 January 2026**, applicants must select **'Taking TOEFL for Australia**’ during registration to ensure the test is valid for Australian visa purposes.

We will not accept TOEFL iBT tests completed between 26 July 2023, and 4 May 2024 for Australian visa and migration purposes. During this period, the TOEFL iBT test being offered was not an approved test.

Cambridge C1 Advanced test (previously known as Cambridge English: Advanced CAE)

From 12 February 2024 to 6 August 2025, the department will only accept results from the Cambridge C1 Advanced paper-based test.

The department will still accept tests taken before 12 February 2024 and within specified validity periods, for C1 Advanced paper-based and computer-based tests.

LANGUAGECERT Academic

If you sit a LANGUAGECERT test, you will receive a ‘certificate’ and a ‘report’. If you use your **LANGUAGECERT Academic** results to show you meet the English language requirement, you must include **both documents** with your visa application. If you do not provide the certificate and the report, **visa processing may be delayed.**

English language evidence exemptions

You do not need to give us evidence of an English test score with your visa application if one of the following applies:

- you are a citizen and hold a passport from UK, USA, Canada, NZ or Republic of Ireland
- you are an applicant who is a Foreign Affairs or Defence sponsored student, or a Secondary Exchange student (AASES)
- you are enrolled in a principal course of study that is a registered school course

- you are enrolled in a principal course of study that is a standalone English Language Intensive Course for Overseas Students (ELICOS)
- you are enrolled in a principal course of study registered and delivered in a language other than English
- you are enrolled in a registered post-graduate research course
- you have completed at least 5 years' study in English in Australia, UK, USA, Canada, New Zealand, South Africa, or the Republic of Ireland
- in the 2 years before applying for the Student visa you completed the Senior Secondary Certificate of Education in Australia in English while you held a Student visa
- in the 2 years before applying for the Student visa you completed a substantial component of a course that would qualify you under the Australian Qualifications Framework at the Certificate IV or higher level, while you held a Student visa.

Note: We may need you to give us evidence of an English test score with your visa application if you hold a British National Overseas (BNO) passport.

If you are required to provide evidence of English language proficiency but you fall into an exemption category, make sure you provide the appropriate evidence that demonstrates that you satisfy one of the exemptions.

For more information on English Language Tests and Evidence Exemptions refer to the Migration (English Language Tests and Evidence Exemptions for Subclass 500 (Student) Visas) Instrument 2025 - Federal Register of Legislation *(https://www.legislation.gov.au/F2025L00906/asmade/text)*.

Have adequate health insurance

You and your family members must have and maintain adequate health insurance *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health/adequate-health-insurance)* for the whole of your stay in Australia. To find out the length of coverage you will require, see Student visa grant periods *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/length-of-stay)*.

You and your family members must be covered by Overseas Student Health Cover (OSHC) *(https://www.privatehealth.gov.au/health_insurance/overseas/overseas_student_health_cover.htm)* from an approved Australian health insurance provider, unless an 'Exception' applies.

Applicants outside Australia

Your cover must start from the day you and your family arrive in Australia, not the day your course starts.

If you have been granted a visa and want to travel to Australia before your course begins, the OSHC start date must be the same as the date you arrive, not the date your course starts. Generally this is a minimum of 1 week to 1 month before your course starts.

You must:

- ensure you don't enter Australia before your OSHC begins, and
- maintain your OSHC until you leave Australia.

You may be refused entry to Australia if you cannot prove you have health insurance in place when you arrive.

Applicants in Australia

Applicants must have OSHC. If your previous visa required you to have health insurance, cover must be continuous with no gap between your previous health cover and your OSHC.

Exceptions

You do not need to have OSHC if you are:

- a Norwegian student covered by the Norwegian National Insurance Scheme
- a Swedish student covered by Kammarkollegiet
- a Belgian student covered under the Reciprocal Health Care Agreement with Australia

How to get Overseas Student Health Cover

To get OSHC:

- find an approved provider
- pay for your policy

Your education provider or agent might arrange OSHC for you.

If your education provider arranges your OSHC coverage, you will need to know the name of your health insurance provider, the date that your policy starts and finishes and should be aware of the terms and conditions of your policy. Your education provider will also need to include your health insurance information on your Certificate of Enrolment (CoE).

If you arrange OSHC coverage yourself, you will need to know the policy number to include in the visa application.

We will refuse your visa application if you don't give us this information when you apply for your Student visa.

Insurance for family members

If you have a single OSHC policy and you have family members, including children born in Australia after your arrival, consider getting a family policy. Every member of your family must have health insurance.

Any family member who joins you after you arrive in Australia must show us they have OSHC for the duration of their stay in Australia.

Apply from the right location

From 2 October 2026, new rules mean that most Student visa applications must be lodged outside Australia.

You can only apply in Australia if you hold an eligible visa and meet an exemption category.

Eligible visas

If you hold a visa as a primary or secondary holder on the list below you cannot apply for a student visa in Australia. **There are no exemptions to this rule.**

- Subclass 400 – Temporary Work (all streams)
- Subclass 403 – (Domestic Worker – Diplomatic/Consular stream)
- Subclass 407 – Training (all streams)
- Subclass 408 – Temporary Activity (all streams)
- Subclass 417 – Working Holiday (all streams)
- Subclass 457 – Temporary Work (all streams)
- Subclass 462 – Work and Holiday (all streams)

- Subclass 482 – Skills in Demand / Temporary Skill Shortage (all streams)
- Subclass 485 – Temporary Graduate
- Subclass 600 – Visitor
- Subclass 601 – ETA
- Subclass 602 – Medical Treatment
- Subclass 651 – eVisitor
- Subclass 771 – Transit
- Subclass 988 – Maritime Crew
- Subclass 995 – Diplomatic (Temporary) *(primary only. A family member of a Diplomatic (Temporary) visa (subclass 995) can apply for a Student visa in Australia)*

Meet an exemption to apply for a further student visa in Australia

If you are student visa holder you may be able to apply for another Student visa while in Australia.

Dependent or secondary student visa holders cannot apply for a student visa as the primary applicant while in Australia.

If you hold a student visa as the primary applicant, you may be able to apply in Australia if you meet one of the six exemptions below.

If you do not meet an exemption, **you should not apply in Australia.** We will not accept your application if you are not eligible and this may have consequences if you are in Australia. An invalid application outcome could affect your visa status and you may not be eligible to apply for a further visa if your visa has already expired. Invalid decisions cannot be merits reviewed at the ART.

Exemption 1 – you need up to 12 additional months to complete your studies.

To apply under this exemption:

- you need up to 12 additional months from the original end date of your main course to finish your course, **and**
- the course you are completing must be the main course in your package of courses (if you are studying packaged courses), **and**
- the course must be with the same education provider that your current Student visa was granted for (you can have changed courses but the course you changed to must be at the same AQF level or higher).

For example, students who have started a Bachelor's Degree can apply for a student visa in Australia if they need up to 12 extra months to finish the same degree or a different Bachelor agree at the same education provider.

Understanding AQF levels and VET courses

The Australian qualifications are ranked from level 1 to level 10 by the Australian Qualifications Framework (AQF) *(https://www.aqf.edu.au/)* . Check the AQF level of your current and proposed course to see whether you meet the course completion exemption.

Exemption 2 – you are sponsored by the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (DFAT) or Defence

To apply under this exemption, you must be sponsored by the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade or the Department of Defence.

Exemption 3 – you are applying to undertake a PhD

To apply under this exemption, you must be applying to study a Doctoral Degree (PhD). You cannot apply under this exemption if you are applying to study a Master's by Research course.

Exemption 4 – you are applying to undertake primary or secondary school studies

To apply under this exemption, you must be applying to study primary or secondary school studies.

Exemption 5 – you have completed your main course and are applying in Australia to undertake another course

To apply under this exemption:

- you must have completed your main course for which your visa was granted for or you have completed a course which was the same or higher AQF level as the original course your student visa was granted for, **and**
- you are progressing to a course at a higher AQF level, **and**
- if your completed course was a higher education course, the course you are progressing to must also be a higher education course delivered by a higher education provider.

You can also apply for this exemption:

- if the main course you completed did not have an AQF level, and you are progressing to a course with an AQF level or
- you have completed your school studies and are progressing to a course that does not have an AQF level.

For example:

- Students who have completed an English Language Intensive Courses for Overseas Students (ELICOS) course can apply for a student visa in Australia if they are progressing to a Bachelor's Degree.
- Students who have completed an ELICOS course cannot apply for a student visa in Australia if they want to study another ELICOS course.
- Students who have completed their secondary school studies can apply for a student visa in Australia if they want to study a foundational course after they finish school.
- Students who have completed a Bachelor's Degree at a higher education provider cannot apply for a student visa in Australia if they want to study a Graduate Diploma course at a VET provider.

Understanding AQF levels and VET courses

The Australian qualifications are ranked from level 1 to level 10 by the Australian Qualifications Framework (AQF) *(https://www.aqf.edu.au/)*. Check the AQF level of your current and proposed course to see whether you meet the course progression exemption.

Exemption 6 – you cannot continue your course because your education provider has defaulted

To apply under this exemption, you must be unable to continue your course because your education provider has defaulted. For more information, see Education provider default *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/education-provider-default)*.

Meet an exemption if you want to include family members

If you meet one of the exemptions below, your family members must apply at the same time and from the same location as you. If your family members are applying with you in Australia, they must hold an eligible visa to apply.

If you do not meet an exemption to include family, you should not lodge an application for your family members. We will not accept your family member's application if they are not eligible and this may have consequences if they are in Australia. An invalid application outcome could affect their visa status and they may not be eligible to apply for a further visa if their visa has already expired. Invalid decisions cannot be merits reviewed at the ART.

Exemption 1 – you are a Doctoral (PhD) student

To include family under this exemption, you must be applying to study a Doctoral Degree (PhD).

You cannot apply under this exemption if you are applying to study a Master's by Research course.

You can include family members when you lodge your visa application **inside or outside Australia.** If your family members are applying in Australia, they must hold an eligible visa or a student visa.

Exemption 2 – you are a Department of Defence or Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade sponsored student

To include family under this exemption, you must be sponsored by the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade or the Department of Defence.

You can include family members when you lodge your visa application **inside or outside Australia.** If your family members are applying in Australia, they must hold an eligible visa or a student visa.

Exemption 3 – you are a foreign government scholarship recipient

To include family under this exemption, you must be receiving a foreign government scholarship that fully funds your studies in Australia.

If you are **outside Australia**, you can include family members when you lodge your application.

If you are **inside Australia**, you can only include family members when you lodge your application if you:

- need up to 12 additional months to complete the main course covered by your current Student visa, or
- have completed your main course and are applying in Australia to undertake another course at a higher Australian Qualifications Framework (AQF) level. if your completed course was a higher education course, the course you are progressing to must also be a higher education course delivered by a higher education provider, or

- need to lodge a further Student visa application because your education provider defaulted.

Exemption 4 – Eligible national from Pacific Island or ASEAN countries

To include family under this exemption, you must be a national from a Pacific Island:

- Federated States of Micronesia
- Fiji
- Kiribati
- Nauru
- Palau
- Papua New Guinea
- Republic of the Marshall Islands
- Samoa
- Solomon Islands
- Tonga
- Tuvalu
- Vanuatu

Or an ASEAN country:

- Brunei Darussalam
- Cambodia
- Indonesia
- Lao Peoples Dem Republic
- Malaysia
- Myanmar
- Philippines
- Singapore
- Thailand
- Timor-Leste
- Vietnam

If you are **outside Australia**, you can include family members when you lodge your application.

If you are **inside Australia**, you can only include family members when you lodge your application if you:

- need up to 12 additional months to complete the main course covered by your current Student visa, or
- have completed your main course and are applying in Australia to undertake another course at a higher Australian Qualifications Framework (AQF) level. If your completed course was a higher education course, the course you are progressing to must also be a higher education course delivered by a higher education provider, or
- need to lodge a further Student visa application because your education provider defaulted.

Exemption 5 – Other exemptions

Current Student visa holders applying inside or outside Australia

If you currently hold a Student visa and you are inside or outside Australia, you can include family members who are currently on your Student visa when you lodge your application, if:

- you need up to 12 additional months to complete your main course covered by your current Student visa, or
- you need to lodge a further Student visa application because your education provider defaulted.

Current student visa holders applying inside Australia

If you currently hold a student visa and you are inside Australia, you can include family members who are currently on your student visa when you lodge your application, if:

- you have completed your main course for which your student visa was granted for or you have completed a course which was the same or higher AQF level as the original course your student visa was granted for, **and**
- you are progressing to a course at a higher AQF level, **and**
- if your completed course was a higher education course, the course you are progressing to must also be a higher education course delivered by a higher education provider.

You can also apply for this exemption:

- if the main course you completed did not have an AQF level, and you are progressing to a course with an AQF level or
- you have completed your school studies and are progressing to a course that does not have an AQF level.

You must have held or applied for a Student visa before 2 October 2026.

Have enough money for your stay

You must have enough money to pay for your stay in Australia. To see the minimum amount of money you need for your visa application go to 'Gather Documents' under Step by Step *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#HowTo)*.

The living costs we ask you to declare and provide with your visa application is the minimum amount of money you need for the visa. Actual living costs vary throughout Australia. They may be much higher than what you need for the visa. We recommend you research the area you intend to live including the cost of living in that area.

You should not rely on work to support yourself or your family while in Australia. The Australian Government Study Australia website *(https://costofliving.studyaustralia.gov.au/)* provides useful information on accommodation options. It features a cost of living calculator to help you consider other possible costs in addition to the amount required for your visa application.

For more information visit Study Australia *(https://costofliving.studyaustralia.gov.au/)*.

Be a genuine student

You must:

- be a genuine student for entry
- be able to show an understanding that studying in Australia is the primary reason of your Student visa.

For more information, see Genuine Student requirement *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/genuine-temporary-entrant)*.

Meet our character requirement

You and family members aged 16 years and over who apply for the visa must meet our character requirement *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/character)*.

Meet our health requirement

You and any family members who apply for the visa must meet our health requirement *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)*.

Sign the Australian values statement

If you are 18 years of age or older, you must:

- have read, or had explained to you, the Life in Australia booklet *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/australian-values)* and
- sign an Australian Values Statement *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/australian-values)* that confirms you will respect the Australian way of life and obey Australian laws

Have paid back your debt to the Australian Government

If you or any family members (including those who don't apply for the visa with you) owe the Australian government money, you or they must have paid it back or arranged to pay it back.

Not had a visa cancelled or an application refused

We will consider your immigration history when we decide on your application, which means you might not be eligible for this visa if you have had a visa cancelled or refused.

If applying for a visa from outside Australia see Can I go to Australia *(/entering-and-leaving-australia/entering-australia/can-i-go-to-australia/re-entry-ban)*.

If you want immigration assistance, see Who can help with your visa application *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/overview)*.

Best interests of the child

We might not grant this visa if it is not in the best interests of an applicant under 18.

Meet all these criteria? Check how to apply in our step by step *(#HowTo)* guide.

Last updated:
12 October 2026